Setup projects and onboard developers in minutes with Vortex

DrupalSouth 2025 Melbourne

About me

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15 years on Drupal.org (alex.skrypnyk)

Drupal and DevOps

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View this presentation

What is onboarding



Onboarding is the process of setting up

the **project structure**, **environment**, **integrations**, and

familiarizing with the processes, **tools**, and **workflows**

to **smoothly contribute** to a project

Project setup and onboarding



Project setup is a necessary part of each project lifecycle

Effective onboarding ensures developers can navigate the setup efficiently and start contributing without delays

Common Onboarding Challenges



- Developers lose hours or days setting up their local, CI and hosting environments
- Inconsistent setups cause false negatives, undermining the reliability of tools
- Lack of understanding of third-party service inner workings slows integration and troubleshooting
- Poor onboarding documentation affects team productivity

The Cost of Slow Onboarding

- 🔥 Developer frustration and burnout
- 🔥 Project delays and missed deadlines
- 🔥 Increased unplanned costs and budget overruns

What Developers Appreciate



- 👍 No unexpected firefighting
- 👍 Familiar project structure and tools
- 👍 Easy setup
- 👍 Automation to reduce manual work
- 👍 Support when things don't work out

👋 Meet Vortex

Project template for Drupal designed to simplify onboarding and website maintenance



Behind the name

Vortex is a structured yet dynamic ecosystem where Drupal acts as the core framework, while Vortex orchestrates everything around it: automation, best practices, scalability, and streamlined development.



Template



Documentation



Installer

🎁 What's inside Vortex?



- 💧 A pre-configured Drupal project structure with module, theme and test boilerplate
- 🧰 Pre-configured tools for code quality checks and automated testing
- 🐳 Docker-based environment for local development and cloud hosting
- 🏗️ CI/CD using GitHub Actions or CircleCI
- 🏠 Built-in support for Acquia and Lagoon hosting platforms
- 📖 Project documentation

💧 Drupal structure



- 💪 Drupal 11 based on `drupal-composer/drupal-project`
- 💪 Configurable webroot
- 💪 Pre-configured settings with tests
- 💪 Custom module and theme boilerplate
- 💪 Tests boilerplate

💧 Drupal structure

- 🏋️ Configuration for site admin modules:

  Environment indicator, Shield, Stage file proxy
- 🏋️ Configuration for Search API (Solr)
- 🏋️ Configuration for caching (Redis)
- 🏋️ Configuration for antivirus (ClamAV)

🧰 Reliable tools



- 📐 Code standards and quality checks:

  PHPCS, PHPMD, PHPStan, Rector, ESLint, Twig CS Fixer

- 🧪 Testing: PHPUnit, Behat

- 🐳 Docker stack

Docker-based environment

- Production-grade open-source Docker images by the Lagoon team
- Docker Compose config for web services, Redis, Solr, ClamAV and Chrome
- Identical local and in CI environment
- Identical environment for hosting if using Lagoon

Adding DDEV support is the next item on our roadmap



CI/CD



- ♻ Github Actions and CircleCI configuration
- ♻ Cached database between builds for faster runs
- ♻ Pre-configured for git-flow
- ♻ Test results and artifacts storage
- ♻ Ignore check failures using variables

🏠 Hosting providers - Acquia

- Environment type identification
- Cloud hooks
- Code artifact packaging

🏠 Hosting providers - Lagoon

- Environment type identification
- Auto-deployment after CI passes
- Auto-env removal when PR closes

📖 Documentation



💡 Centralised documentation at

https://vortex.drevops.com/

Introduction
Getting started
Drupal
Tools
CI
Hosting
Workflows

Main features
Quick start
Contributing
License



Vortex

Drupal project template

Welcome to **Vortex** — a project template for Drupal designed to simplify onboarding and website maintenance.

At DrevOps®, we carefully maintain this template, keeping it aligned with the latest tools and validating it through automated tests to ensure everything works together seamlessly.

Our goal is to provide a consistent developer experience across projects, making it easier to switch between them and get up to speed quickly.

📖 Documentation



- 💡 Centralised documentation at https://vortex.drevops.com/
- 💡 Documentation scaffold for your project

README

Your project

Drupal 11 implementation

Database, Build, Test and Deploy passing | Drupal 11 | Automated updates RenovateBot

Vortex 25.11.0

Environments

- **PROD:** https://yoursite.com/
- **DEV:** https://dev.yoursite.com/

Local environment setup

- Make sure that you have latest versions of all required software installed: Docker, Pygmy, Ahoy
- Make sure that all local web development services are shut down (Apache/Nginx, Mysql, MAMP etc).
- Checkout project repository (in one of the supported Docker directories).
- Authenticate with Lagoon
  i. Create an SSH key and add it to your account in the Lagoon Dashboard.
  ii. Copy `.env.local.example` to `.env.local`.
  iii. Update `$VORTEX_DB_DOWNLOAD_SSH_FILE` environment variable in `.env.local` file with the path to the SSH key.
- `ahoy download-db`
- `pygmy up`
- `ahoy build`

Name	Last commit message
..	
README.md	
ci.md	
deployment.md	
faqs.md	
onboarding.md	
releasing.md	
testing.md	

README.md

Project-specific documentation.

- Onboarding checklist
- Testing
- CI
- Deployment
- Releasing
- FAQs

📖 Documentation

- 💡 Centralised documentation at https://vortex.drevops.com/
- 💡 Documentation scaffold for your project
- 💡 Onboarding checklist to track the progress of the onboarding to Vortex

Onboarding checklist

Use this checklist to track the process of migration of the existing site to Vortex. This file is intended to be committed into repository until onboarding process is finished.

Put a `x` into `[ ]` if this step was executed OR not required - this will indicate that it was addressed.

---

1. Assessing current site

- [ ] Setup site on local machine using MAMP to bootstrap the project.
- [ ] Install hacked module and extract a list of all modules with their versions. Add them below:

```
Add a list of extracted modules here.
```

- [ ] Find existing patches or create new patches for all "hacked" modules. List them below:

```
ctools: https:/drupal.org/path/to/file.patch
```

- [ ] Assess if there are any libraries used in the project, find their versions together with download URLs, and list them below:

```
ckeditor@4.3.2, https://www.ckeditor.com/archive/ckeditor_4.3.2.zip
```



Automations



Dependency updates with Renovate

- Separate schedules for core and contribs
- Updates PHP, JS, container images and GitHub actions

Dependency Dashboard #1006

Open

renovate opened on Sep 27, 2023 · edited by renovate — Edits

This issue lists Renovate updates and detected dependencies. Read the Dependency Dashboard docs to learn more.
View this repository on the Mend.io Web Portal.

This repository currently has no open or pending branches.

Detected dependencies

- ▶ composer
- ▶ docker-compose
- ▶ dockerfile
- ▶ github-actions
- ▶ regex

☐ Check this box to trigger a request for Renovate to run again on this repository

Create sub-issue

Update Container images to v25.2.0 #1547

Merged — AlexSkrypnyk merged 1 commit into `develop` from `deps/docker` 2 weeks ago

Conversation 1 | Commits 1 | Checks 21 | Files changed 7

renovate bot commented 3 weeks ago

This PR contains the following updates:

Package	Type	Update	Change
uselagoon/commons	stage	minor	`25.1.0` -> `25.2.0`
uselagoon/mysql-8.4		minor	`25.1.0` -> `25.2.0`
uselagoon/mysql-8.4	final	minor	`25.1.0` -> `25.2.0`
uselagoon/nginx-drupal	final	minor	`25.1.0` -> `25.2.0`
uselagoon/php-8.3-cli-drupal	final	minor	`25.1.0` -> `25.2.0`
uselagoon/php-8.3-fpm	final	minor	`25.1.0` -> `25.2.0`
uselagoon/redis-6		minor	`25.1.0` -> `25.2.0`
uselagoon/solr-8	final	minor	`25.1.0` -> `25.2.0`

Release Notes

▶ uselagoon/lagoon-images (uselagoon/commons)



Automations



- Dependency updates with Renovate
  - Separate schedules for core and contribs
  - Updates PHP, JS, container images and GitHub actions
- Auto-assign PR author
- Auto-add a CONFLICT label to PRs



Solid base for your projects



- Upgradable
- Automatically tested in different scenarios
- Actively maintained as a product since 2017
- Heavily documented at https://vortex.drevops.com/



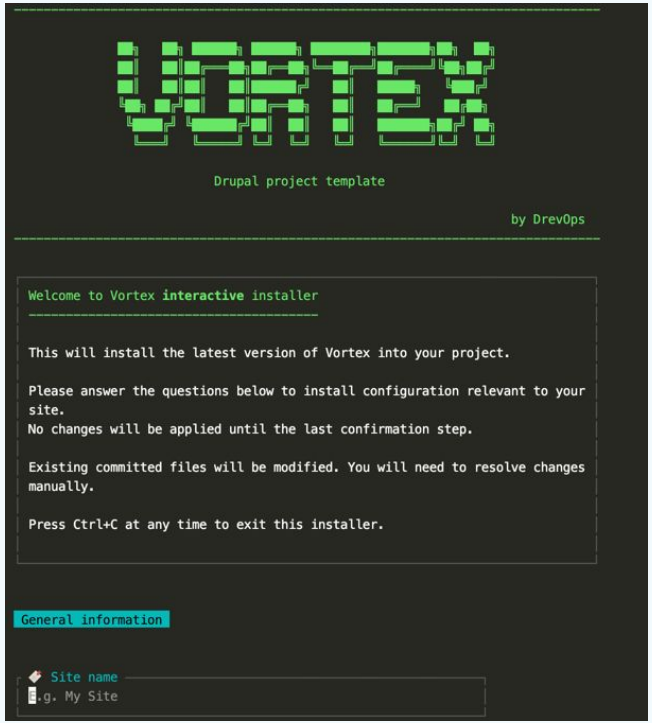
How to start



Use the installer:

```
curl -SsL https://vortex.drevops.com/install > i.php && i.php
```

How to start


VORTEX
Drupal project template
by DrevOps
Welcome to Vortex interactive installer
This will install the latest version of Vortex into your project.
Please answer the questions below to install configuration relevant to your site.
No changes will be applied until the last confirmation step.
Existing committed files will be modified. You will need to resolve changes manually.
Press Ctrl+C at any time to exit this installer.
General information
Site name
e.g. My Site


General information
Site name star wars
Site machine name star_wars
Organization name star wars Org
Organization machine name star_wars_org
Public domain star-wars.com
Code repository
Code provider github
GitHub access token valid
GitHub repository star_wars_org/star_wars
Drupal
Webroot docroot
Use a custom profile No
Module prefix sw
Theme machine name star_wars
Hosting
Hosting provider acquia
Deployment
Deployment types artifact
Workflow
Provision type database
Database dump source acquia
Continuous Integration
CI provider gha
Automations
Dependency updates provider renovatebot_ci
Auto-assign PR author Yes
Auto-add a CONFLICT label to PRs Yes
Documentation
Preserve project documentation Yes
Preserve onboarding checklist Yes
Locations
Current directory star_wars
Destination directory star_wars
Vortex repository https://github.com/drevops/vortex.git@stable

Extensible installer

- 🙌 Symfony console application
- 🙌 Uses laravel/prompts for TUI
- 🙌 Flexible API to add new integrations
- 🙌 Testing harness

What's next for Vortex

- More integrations and tooling:
  - DDEV
  - Lando
  - Platform.sh
- Further setup automation improvements
- Growing community adoption

📢 Help needed

- Ideas and feedback
- Testing
- Extending integrations
- Developing

Q&A

https://www.vortextemplate.com/

